

FLICKER

1. Passage anchor

> “As evening fell and the lights of the park ****flickered on****, I looked at Kelvin...”

Passage meaning

****flicker on**** = begin to shine or come on with a brief, unsteady, or fluttering light

****閃爍著亮起；一盞盞忽明忽暗地亮起****

Here, the park lights begin coming on as evening arrives. ****Flickered on**** gives the scene a slightly visual, atmospheric feeling: the lights do not simply “turn on”; they seem to ****glimmer or flash into life****.

Practice

1. The streetlights ****flickered on**** as it grew dark.

天色漸暗時，街燈****閃爍著亮了起來****。

2. One by one, the lights ****flickered on**** around the park.

樂園四周的燈光一盞接一盞****閃爍著亮起****。

Core meanings of FLICKER

2. flicker — shine unsteadily

As a verb:

= shine with a light that repeatedly becomes brighter and dimmer

****閃爍；忽明忽暗****

Examples

1. The candle ****flickered**** in the wind.

蠟燭在風中****閃爍****。

2. The lights ****flickered**** during the storm.

暴風雨期間，燈光一直****忽明忽暗****。

This is the central literal sense.

3. flicker — flame move unsteadily

= move or burn with small, quick, irregular movements

****搖曳；閃動****

Examples

1. Flames ****flickered**** in the fireplace.

火焰在壁爐裡****搖曳閃動****。

2. The candle flame ****flickered**** gently.

燭火輕輕地****搖曳****。

This is closely connected to the light sense.

Flicker on / off

4. flicker on

= begin to shine or appear with a brief or unsteady light

****閃爍著亮起；忽然亮起****

This is the exact passage construction.

Examples

1. The screen ****flickered on****.

螢幕****閃了一下後亮起****。

2. The hallway lights ****flickered on**** automatically.

走廊的燈自動****閃爍著亮起****。

5. flicker off

= go out or disappear with a brief flash or unstable light

****閃爍著熄滅；閃了一下後關掉****

Examples

1. The old television ****flickered off****.

舊電視****閃了一下後熄掉****。

2. The lights ****flickered off**** for a second.

燈光****閃爍著熄了一下****。

Electricity / unstable lighting

6. flicker — light because of electrical instability

= rapidly switch between brighter/dimmer or on/off because of an electrical problem

****閃爍；忽亮忽暗****

Examples

1. The lamp keeps ****flickering****.

那盞燈一直****閃爍不定****。

2. The lights started ****flickering**** before the power went out.

停電之前，燈光開始****忽明忽暗****。

Common real-world use.

Screen / display

7. flicker — image/screen flash unsteadily

= rapidly vary in brightness or visibility on a television, monitor, phone, projector, etc.

****螢幕閃爍；畫面抖閃****

Examples

1. The computer screen began to ****flicker****.

電腦螢幕開始****閃爍****。

2. The image ****flickered**** for a few seconds.

畫面****閃動****了幾秒。

Major modern technical application.

8. screen flicker

= rapid unwanted change in screen brightness or image stability

****螢幕閃爍****

Examples

1. The update caused noticeable ****screen flicker****.
更新後出現明顯的****螢幕閃爍****。
2. High refresh rates can reduce visible ****flicker****.
較高的更新率可以減少肉眼可見的****閃爍****。

Noun: unsteady light

9. flicker — brief/unsteady light

As a noun:

= small, quick, unsteady flash of light
****閃光；閃爍****

Examples

1. We saw the ****flicker of a candle**** through the window.
我們從窗外看到燭光的****閃爍****。
2. A faint ****flicker**** appeared in the distance.
遠處出現了一點微弱的****閃光****。

Brief facial expression

10. flicker — brief expression on the face

= very brief appearance of an emotion in someone's eyes or facial expression
****一閃而過的表情；短暫流露****

Examples

1. A ****flicker of surprise**** crossed his face.
他臉上閃過一絲****驚訝****。
2. I noticed a ****flicker of doubt**** in her eyes.
我注意到她眼中閃過一絲****懷疑****。

Major figurative sense.

11. flicker across someone's face

= appear very briefly as a facial expression

在某人臉上一閃而過

Examples

1. A smile **flickered across her face**.

她臉上**閃過一絲笑意**。

2. Fear **flickered across his face** for a moment.

恐懼在他臉上**一閃而過**。

Very useful descriptive construction.

Brief emotion / feeling

12. flicker of hope / interest / fear

= very small or short-lived amount of an emotion or attitude

一絲希望 / 興趣 / 恐懼

Examples

1. She felt a **flicker of hope**.

她心中燃起一絲**希望**。

2. His words produced a **flicker of interest**.

他的話令對方產生了一絲**興趣**。

13. flicker — emotion appears briefly

As a verb:

= appear for a very short time as a feeling or expression

短暫閃現；一閃而過

Examples

1. Doubt **flickered in his mind**.

一絲懷疑在他心中**閃過**。

2. A smile **flickered** on her lips.

她嘴角**閃過一絲笑意**。

Brief thought / memory

14. flicker through / across someone's mind

= appear very briefly in thought or memory

在腦海中一閃而過

Examples

1. A strange thought **flickered through my mind**.

一個奇怪的想法在我腦中**一閃而過**。

2. The memory **flickered across his mind**.

那段記憶在他腦海中**短暫閃現**。

Literary but useful.

Very small sign of life / activity

15. flicker of life

= faint sign that something is still alive, active, or functioning

一絲生機；微弱跡象

Examples

1. There was still a **flicker of life** in the old neighborhood.

那個老社區仍有一點**生氣**。

2. The damaged screen showed a faint **flicker of life**.

損壞的螢幕仍顯出一絲**運作跡象**。

16. flicker into life

= begin functioning, glowing, moving, etc. weakly or gradually

****閃爍著啟動；逐漸有了動靜****

Examples

1. The old screen ****flickered into life****.

舊螢幕****閃了幾下後亮了起來****。

2. The lights ****flickered into life**** at dusk.

黃昏時，燈光****閃爍著亮了起來****。

Very close to the passage image.

Small amount of hope / possibility

17. a flicker of hope

= small sign that a situation may improve

****一線希望；一絲希望****

Examples

1. The news gave them a ****flicker of hope****.

那個消息給了他們****一線希望****。

2. There was still a ****flicker of hope**** that he might recover.

他仍有可能康復，還存在****一絲希望****。

FLICKERING

18. flickering — producing unsteady light

= shining with rapid small changes in brightness

****閃爍的；忽明忽暗的****

Examples

1. They sat beside a ****flickering fire****.

他們坐在****搖曳閃爍的火光****旁。

2. The room was lit by a ****flickering candle****.

房間由一支**閃爍的蠟燭**照亮。

19. flickering — appearing/disappearing briefly

Figurative:

= appearing weakly or intermittently

若隱若現的；短暫閃現的

Examples

1. A **flickering hope** remained.

仍殘留著一絲**若隱若現的希望**。

2. He gave a **flickering smile**.

他露出一個**一閃即逝的微笑**。

Less common than noun constructions such as **a flicker of hope**.

Flickering lights in atmosphere / storytelling

20. flickering light

= light whose brightness changes irregularly, often creating a dramatic or atmospheric effect

閃爍的光；搖曳的光

Examples

1. The **flickering light** made the room feel eerie.

忽明忽暗的燈光令房間顯得詭異。

2. Faces appeared in the **flickering firelight**.

一張張臉在**搖曳的火光**中顯現。

Specialist noun: bird

21. flicker — a type of woodpecker

North American bird name:

= a woodpecker of the genus *Colaptes*, especially the northern flicker

****撲動鴛 / 一類啄木鳥****

Examples

1. A northern ****flicker**** landed on the tree.

一隻北方****撲動鴛****停在樹上。

2. We spotted a ****flicker**** near the trail.

我們在小徑附近看到一隻****撲動鴛****。

Established lexical sense, but low priority for general learners.

Key contrasts

22. flicker vs flash

****flash****

= appear or shine very brightly and briefly, often once or in sudden bursts

****閃光；閃一下****

****flicker****

= shine unsteadily with repeated small changes in brightness

****閃爍；忽明忽暗****

Compare:

> lightning flashed

> 閃電一閃

> candle flickered

> 燭火搖曳閃爍

23. flicker vs blink — light

****blink****

= switch on and off at clearer repeated intervals

****—閃—閃；明滅****

****flicker****

= vary rapidly and irregularly in brightness

****忽明忽暗地閃爍****

Compare:

> warning light blinked

> 警示燈規律閃動

> old lamp flickered

> 舊燈忽明忽暗

24. flicker vs shimmer

****shimmer****

= shine with a soft, gently changing reflected light

****微微閃光；閃耀****

****flicker****

= rapidly and somewhat irregularly brighten and dim

****閃爍不定****

Compare:

> water shimmered in the sunlight

> 水面在陽光下閃耀

> candle flickered in the wind

> 燭火在風中搖曳

25. flicker vs glow

****glow****

= give out steady, soft light

****發出柔和持續的光****

****flicker****

= give out unsteady light

****忽明忽暗****

Compare:

> coals glowed

> 煤炭持續發出紅光

> flames flickered

> 火焰搖曳閃爍

26. flicker vs sparkle

****sparkle****

= reflect or emit many small bright points of light

****閃閃發光****

****flicker****

= brightness repeatedly changes or appears/disappears

****閃爍不定****

27. flicker vs flutter

****flutter****

= move rapidly and lightly back and forth

****飄動；顫動****

****flicker****

= often concerns light, flame, expression, or a very brief appearance

****閃爍；閃現****

A flame can ****flicker****, while a flag may ****flutter****.

Meaning map

The central physical image behind ****flicker**** is:

****something rapidly appearing, disappearing, brightening, or dimming****

From this develop:

A. Light

Passage

lights flickered on

→ ****燈光閃爍著亮起****

Candle

candle flickers

→ **燭光忽明忽暗**

Electricity

lamp flickers

→ **燈因電力問題閃爍**

Screen

screen flickers

→ **螢幕閃爍**

B. Expression

Face

a smile flickers across the face

→ **一絲笑意在臉上一閃而過**

Eyes

flicker of doubt

→ **眼中一閃而過的懷疑**

C. Emotion / thought

Hope

flicker of hope

→ **一絲希望**

Interest

flicker of interest

→ **一絲興趣**

Memory

memory flickers through the mind

→ **記憶在腦海中一閃而過**

The shared semantic concept remains:

something is visible or present only weakly, irregularly, or for a very short time.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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flicker — light	光線快速、無規律地變亮變暗；閃爍 / 忽明忽暗
flicker — flame	火焰小幅快速搖動並閃爍；搖曳
flicker on	以短暫 / 不穩定的光閃爍著亮起
flicker off	閃爍一下後熄滅 / 消失
flicker — electrical light	因電力不穩等原因令燈光忽亮忽暗
flicker — screen/display	螢幕 / 畫面亮度快速變化、出現閃爍
screen flicker	螢幕快速不穩定的亮暗變化；螢幕閃爍
a flicker — light	短暫、微弱或不穩定的一閃 / 閃光
a flicker of emotion	某種情緒短暫地流露 / 一閃而過
flicker across someone's face	某種表情在臉上一閃而過
flicker of hope	很微弱但仍存在的一絲 / 一線希望
flicker of interest/doubt/fear	短暫出現的一絲興趣、懷疑或恐懼
flicker — emotion/thought	情緒、念頭等短暫閃現
flicker through/across someone's mind	想法 / 記憶在腦海中一閃而過
flicker of life	極微弱的生命、活動或功能跡象
flicker into life	原本沒有動靜的燈、螢幕等閃爍著開始運作
flickering — light	持續忽明忽暗、搖曳閃爍的
flickering — figurative	若隱若現、短暫出現的
flicker — bird	北美一類啄木鳥；撲動鴛

Passage recap

> “As evening fell and the lights of the park **flickered on**...”

Here:

flicker on = **to begin shining with a brief, fluttering, or slightly unsteady light**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **閃爍著亮起**
* **一盞盞亮了起來**
* **忽明忽暗地亮起**

Natural contextual translation:

隨著夜幕降臨，樂園的燈光一盞盞閃爍著亮起。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

flicker

= **to shine or appear with quick, slight, irregular changes in brightness**

閃爍；忽明忽暗

In the exact phrase:

> **lights flickered on**
> → **燈光閃爍著亮起**

The biggest learner splits are:

> **candle flickers**
> → 燭火**搖曳閃爍**

> **screen flickers**
> → 螢幕**閃爍**

> **a flicker of hope**
> → **一絲希望**

> **a flicker of doubt**
> → **一閃而過的懷疑**

> **a smile flickered across his face**
> → 他臉上**閃過一絲笑意**

> **a thought flickered through my mind**
> → 一個念頭在我腦中**一閃而過**

The most useful contrast is:

> **flash**
> → 突然、短促地**閃一下**

whereas:

> ****flicker****

> → 光線反覆、細微而不穩定地****忽明忽暗****

So in the passage, ****flickered on**** is not merely functional “turned on.” It gives the evening scene a softer visual quality: the park lights ****begin to glow in small, flickering bursts as darkness arrives****.